

Tofte Township 2024 Annual Meeting Minutes

Present: Supervisor Craig Horak, Supervisor Sam Crowley, Treasurer April Fredrick, Clerk Gordon Engstrom, Fire Chief Richie Nelson, Rescue Chief Kim Jahnke, County Commissioner Ginny Storlie

Unless otherwise stated, all actions have been approved by unanimous yea vote.

1. Clerk Gordon called the meeting to order at 8:01 PM on March 12, 2024, at Birch Grove Community Center. All attendees were asked to sign in.
2. Clerk Gordon called for meeting nominations of the meeting moderator. Supervisor Craig nominated Greg Fangel. Supervisor Sam seconded. Clerk Gordon called for any other nominations, with no response, called for a vote to appoint Greg Fangel as the meeting Moderator.
3. Moderator Greg asked those in attendance to stand and recite the Pledge of Allegiance.
4. Approval of Agenda – Clerk Gordon moved to approve the agenda. Supervisor Sam seconded.
5. 2023 Annual Meeting minutes were motioned for approval by Clerk Gordon. Rescue Chief Kim Jahnke seconded.
6. Clerk's Financial Report –
 - a. **Grand Marais State Bank –**

i. General Fund:	121,996.62
ii. Road & Bridge Fund:	43,210.01
iii. Fire Department:	13,878.17
iv. Rescue:	117,338.16
v. General Capital Projects:	101,817.00
vi. Various CDs:	421,218.13
 - b. **North Shore Federal Credit Union –**

i. General Fund:	55,054.23
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 - c. **Charles Schwab –**

i. General Fund:	313,244.62
ii. Water & Sewer – Capital Project:	31,903.67
iii. Birch Grove Building Fund:	99,076.17
iv. Cemetery Sinking Fund:	31,239.27
v. Park Sinking Fund:	82,783.83
vi. Fire Truck Sinking Fund:	164,447.31
vii. Rescue Truck Sinking Fund:	<u>37,128.88</u>
 - d. Grand Total: 1,333,775.49 | - e. The report indicated there was no outstanding debt. Rescue Chief Kim Jahnke motioned to approve the report. Fire Chief Richie Nelson seconded.

Election Results – Supervisor Sam Crowley was elected with 16 unanimous votes. Clerk Gordon Engstrom was elected Treasurer with 16 unanimous votes. Treasurer April Fredrick was elected Clerk with 16 unanimous votes.

REPORTS:

COUNTY COMMISSIONER:

County Commissioner Ginny Storlie shared enthusiastically noted the North Shore Scenic Drive – Highway 61 to be redone in 2027 from tofte to the county line. In discussion with the department of agriculture, commissioner ginny noted the boundary waters 10-year assessment was appraised at \$7.5 million. it will be reappraised in 2028. Previously, cook county was triple a bonded with Ehlers financial firm. A new firm in new jersey won the vote to house the cook county capital improvements fund. there will be improvements made to the cook county highway department, law enforcement, security, heating, and potentially the justice center. Commissioner Ginny offered a pamphlet to understanding property taxation in cook county.

COMMUNITY CENTER:

The township, in coordination with the Tofte Community Garden Club, has developed a Community Garden outside of the Community Center. Treasurer April worked with Liz Wagner and Beverly Flood to put together the online portal for Plot Purchases.

The township is currently working on building improvements for the Community Center including carpet replacement, rug replacement, and a gym floor replacement.

PARK REPORT:

** NEED UPDATE HERE **

FIRE/RESCUE:

Chief Richard Nelson reported 22 calls were responded to in the past year. Seven (7) False Alarms, Three (3) Car responses, two (2) medical assistance calls, One (1) Fire. There were five (5) extreme mutual aid responses as well as three (3) electrical or gas related calls. Local Firefighters & New members sit within the 12-13-member range. He also discussed the possibility of ordering new supplies like electrical car blankets. He discussed he is in communication with the county attorney molly Hicken to address the Lutsen water tank as well as a concern that the Fire hydrants that were installed are running at 700-800 psi which is outside of regulatory fire mandate. Fire Chief Richard also discussed how the fire fighters are preparing for wild fire season in coordination with the forest service. In order to be fully prepared, chief Richard nelson discussed damage the fleet had acquired throughout the year. he intends to replace a fire tanker truck or at the very least a replacement tank. 144 hours had been spent in training throughout the year, two-three (2-3) trainings completed before April. Any and all allegations concerning the Lutsen mountains fire are not involved with the tofte fire department. Chief Richard Nelson noted the fire department is doing well and is extremely proud to lead the organization behind dedicated team members. he thanks them for their service.

Rescue chief Kim Jahnke reported 58 calls throughout the year including 3 vehicular responses and one (1) snowmobile response. two (2) members of the team have taken a refresher course with another one to follow in the year. The crew is up to nine (9) members. there is a new ambulance director who is performing impressive responses with the crew.

TOWN BOARD:

Supervisor Craig Horak thanks Clerk Gordon Engstrom for stepping up into the role after Kay Spielman's passing. He especially wanted to thank Clerk Gordon for the additional work he had put in to re-organize the towns financial health.

Supervisor Craig noted the Tofte Park Road project will be delayed until 2025.

2025 Budget/Levy Discussion:

Approval of 2025 Levy:

Additional Business: